4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: November 2025. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

November 2025 Locked November 2025 is locked (closed 2 Dec 2025). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 40.5% gross margin in November: maintenance contracts the most (63.8%), installations the least (31.3%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

November's jobs made $79,024 gross margin (40.5%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $12,104 and overheads $57,960, leaving $8,960 profit before tax (4.6% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 35.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$79,024
Technician wages and on-costs	$62,016
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$49,912
Technician time not charged to jobs	$12,104
Gross profit (the P&L)	$66,920
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$57,960
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$8,960
Revenue	$194,966
Gross margin on jobs, %	40.5%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	4.6%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**35.9%**

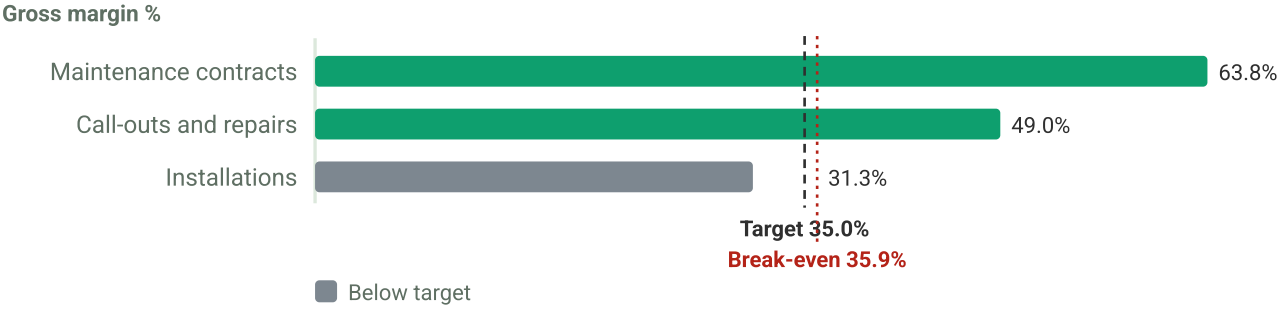
Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, November · All jobs
40.5%
target 35.0%

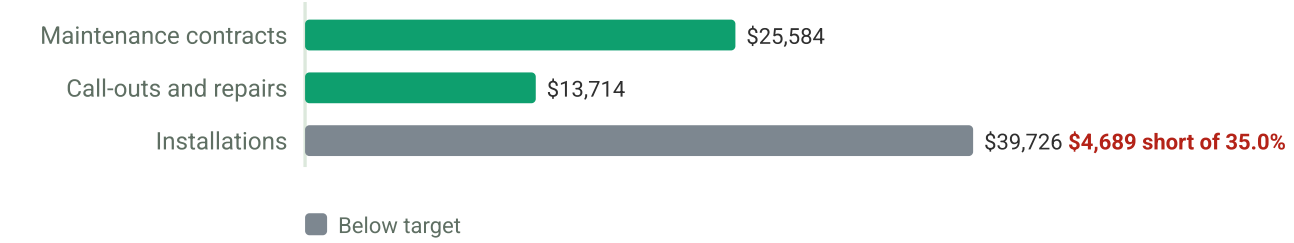
Job gross margin, October · All jobs
44.7%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
35.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (November)

Job gross margin by type of job, November 2025



Gross margin $



What it shows

In November maintenance contracts made a 63.8% job gross margin, installations made a 31.3% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 49.0% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 35.9% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 31.3% gross margin, 3.7 points under the 35.0% target: about $4,689 on $126,900 of revenue in November. It's below the 35.9% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in November).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

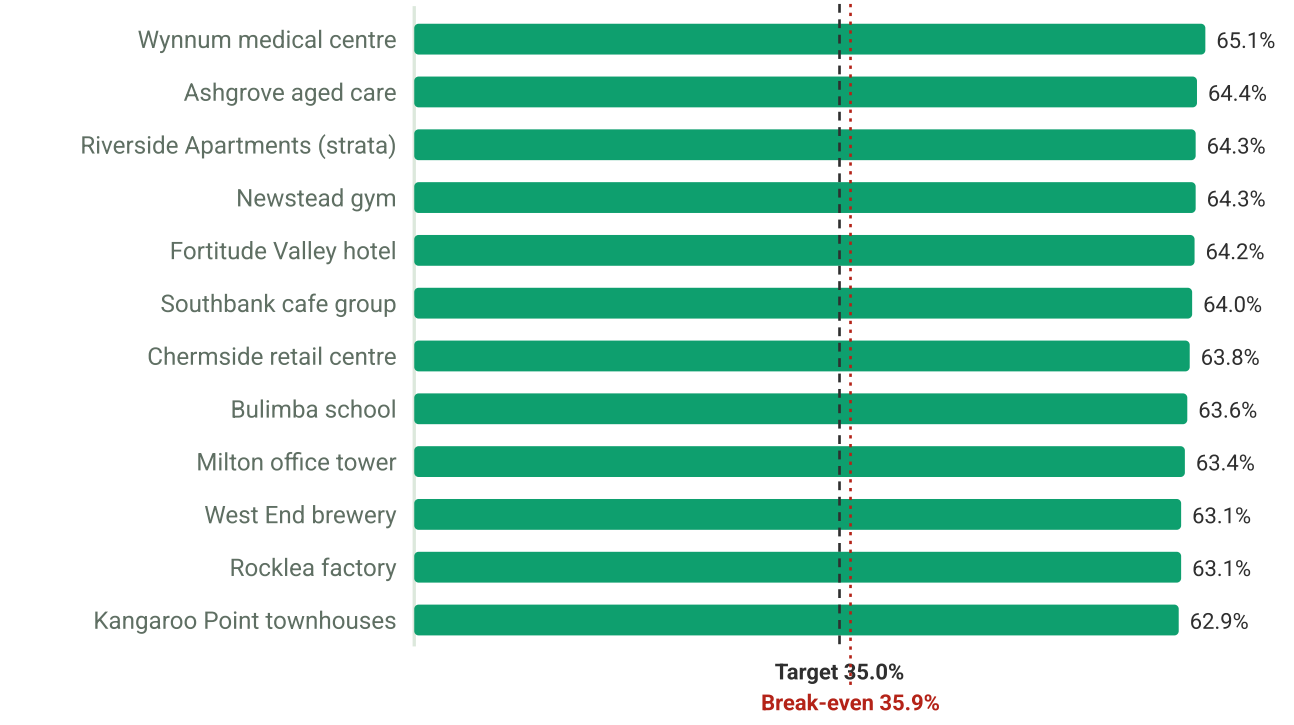
Job gross margin, November · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, October · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

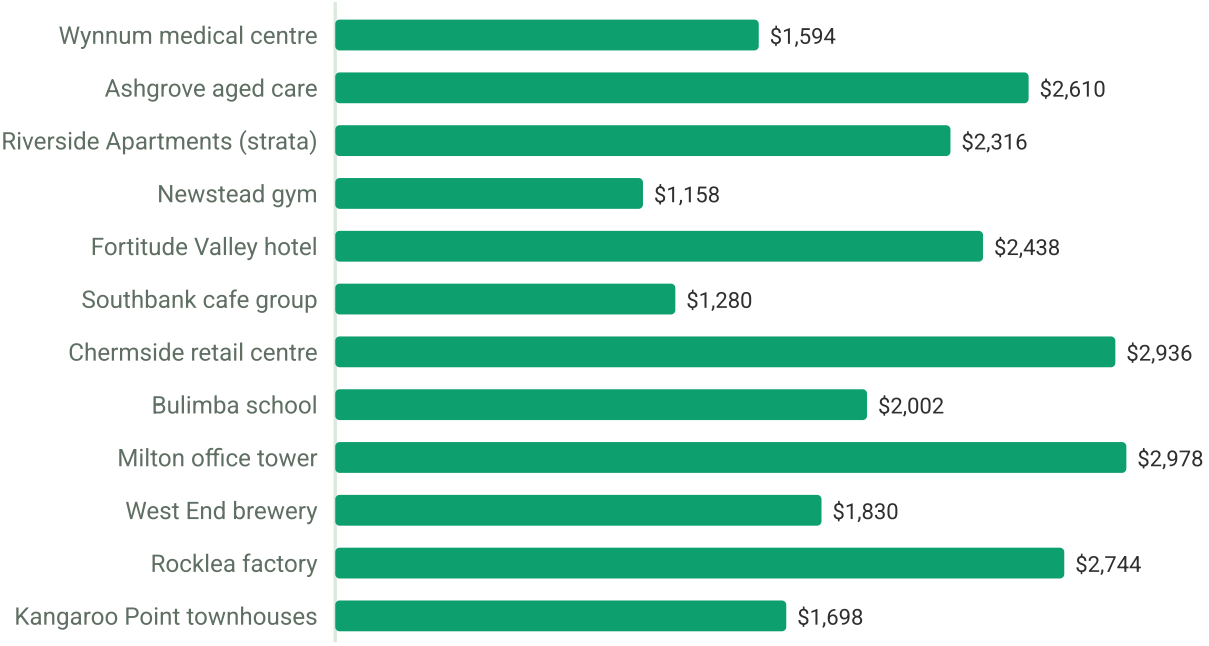
Gross margin jobs need to break even
35.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (November)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, November 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in November). All maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in November).

Type of job: Installations

Job gross margin, November · Installations
31.3%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, October · Installations
34.1%
target 35.0%

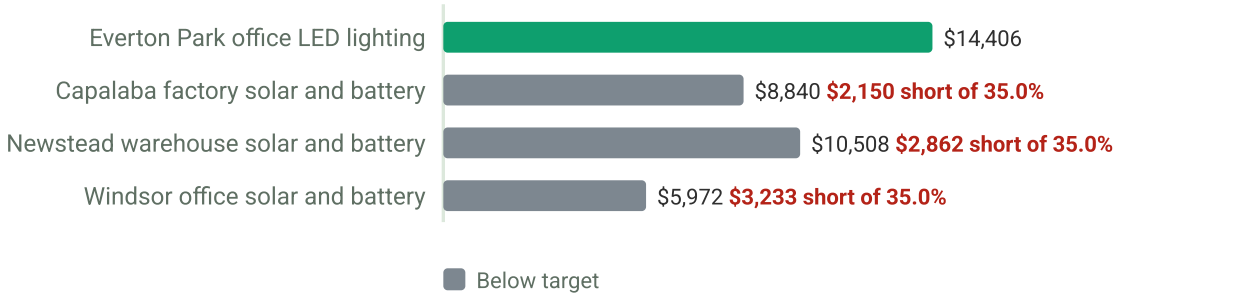
Gross margin jobs need to break even
35.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (November)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in November 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

3 of the 4 installation jobs invoiced in November made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Windsor office solar and battery made a 22.7% job gross margin: 96.0 h of technician time ($6,528) and $2,600 of subcontractors on a $26,300 job. Jobs need 35.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

3 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about $8,245 between them on $95,900 of revenue. The biggest gap, Windsor office solar and battery: 22.7% gross margin, 12.3 points under the 35.0% target: about $3,233 on $26,300 of revenue in November. It's below the 35.9% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, November · Call-outs and repairs
49.0%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, October · Call-outs and repairs
47.7%
target 35.0%

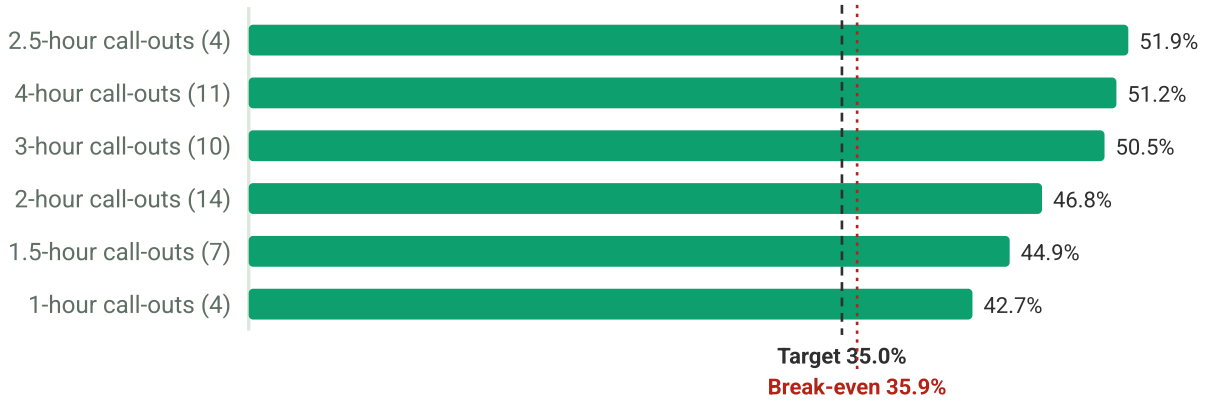
Gross margin jobs need to break even
35.9%
covers overheads and time not charged (November)

Technician time charged, November
$20,621
73.7% of call-out revenue

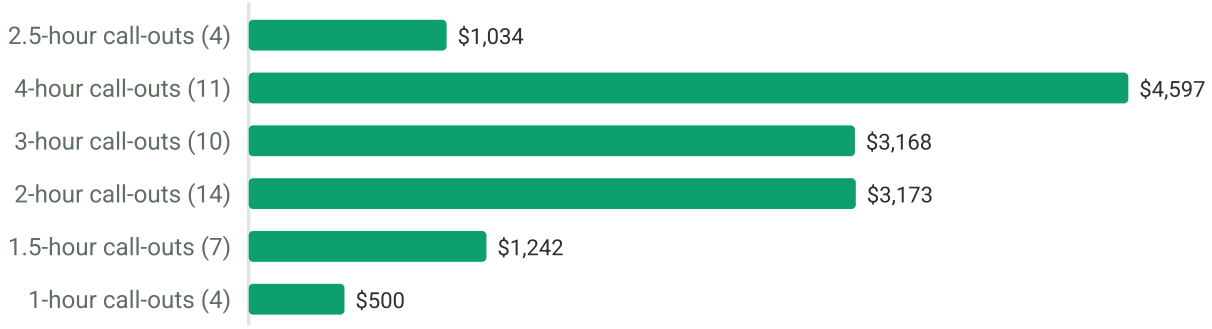
Materials charged, November
$7,345
$5,650 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, November 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

50 call-outs in November billed $20,621 of technician time and $7,345 of materials ($5,650 at cost plus 30%), and made a 49.0% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 42.7% to 51.9% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

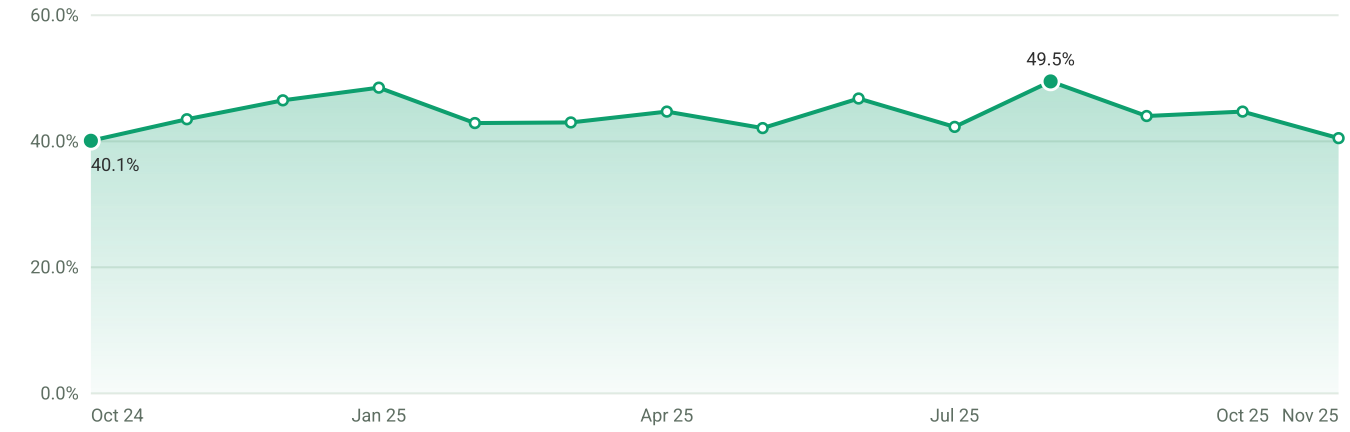
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 49.0% gross margin, 14.0 points over the 35.0% target ($3,926 ahead on $27,966 in November).

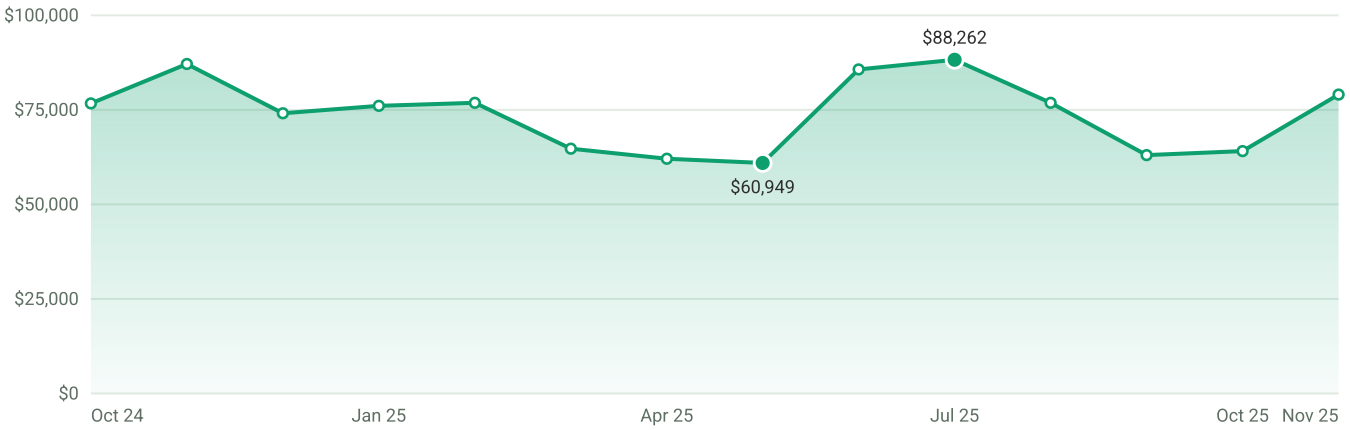
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.